

Identity Lifecycle Management in Okta

Joiner, Mover and Leaver Automation

Project Overview

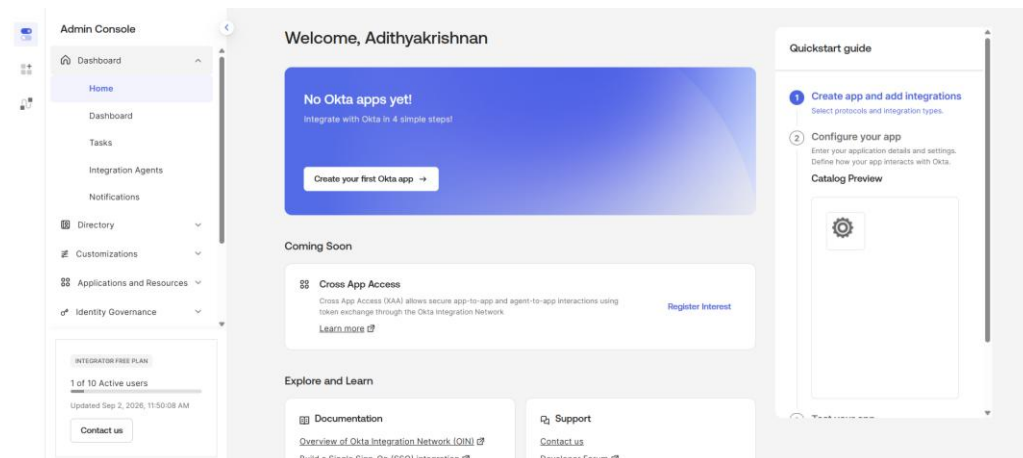
This project involved building a practical Identity and Access Management environment in Okta for a fictional organisation, Meridian Trust Bank.

The objective was to design an identity lifecycle where application access is driven by user attributes and group membership rather than by manually assigning applications to individual users.

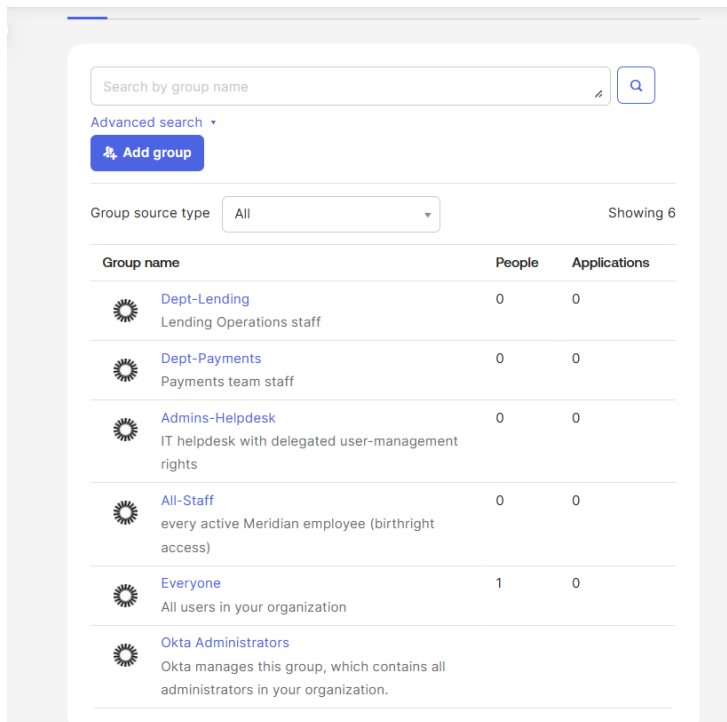
The project focused on the Joiner, Mover and Leaver lifecycle. A new employee was onboarded into the appropriate department, access was automatically changed when the employee moved to another department, and access was removed when the employee left the organisation.

The environment was then strengthened by configuring multi-factor authentication, a stronger password policy and a delegated Help Desk Administrator role based on the principle of least privilege.

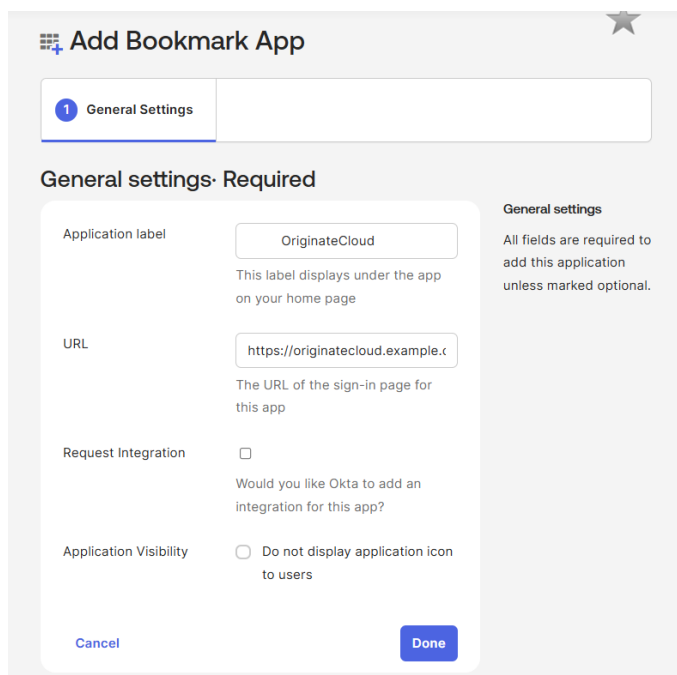
This reflects the core IAM principle described in the project guide: access should be derived from identity information so that when a person's role changes, their access changes with it.



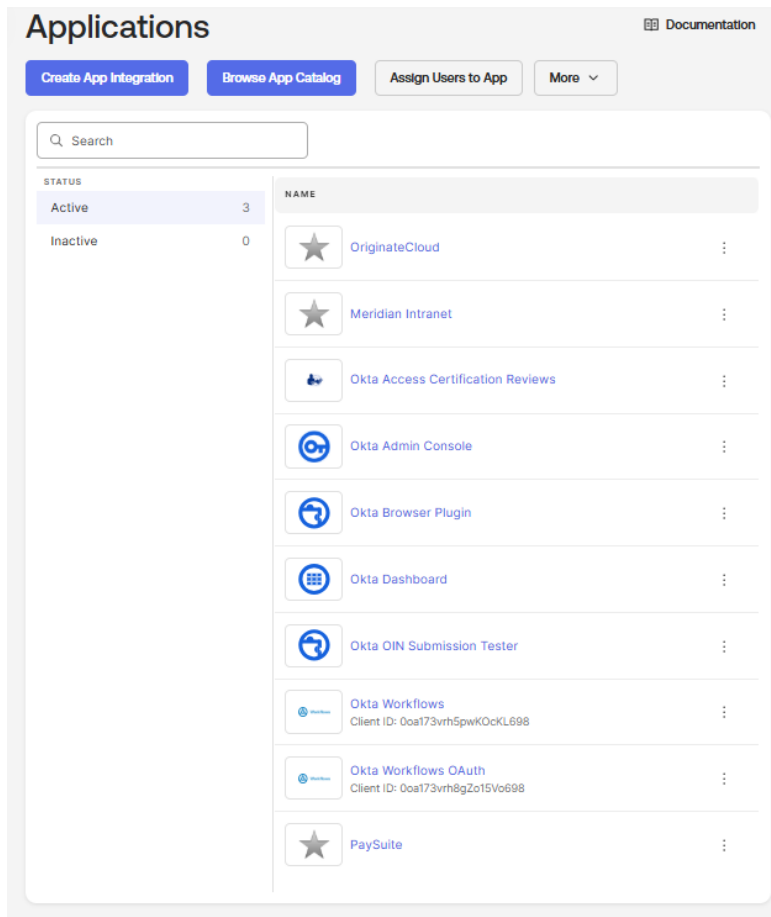
The Okta Admin Console is used to configure directory objects, application access, authentication controls and identity lifecycle policies.



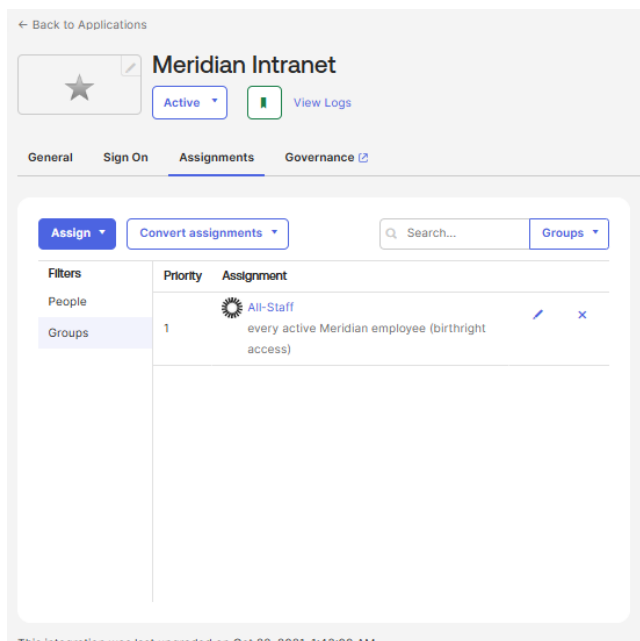
Created the four main groups required for the lab: Dept-Lending, Dept-Payments, All-Staff, and Admins-Helpdesk. These groups were used to control access based on user roles rather than assigning applications directly to individuals.



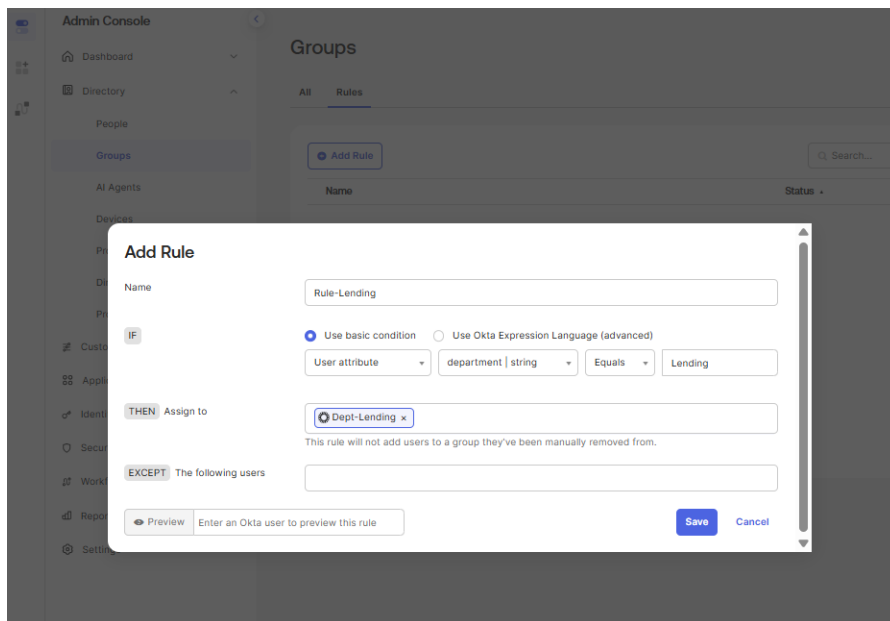
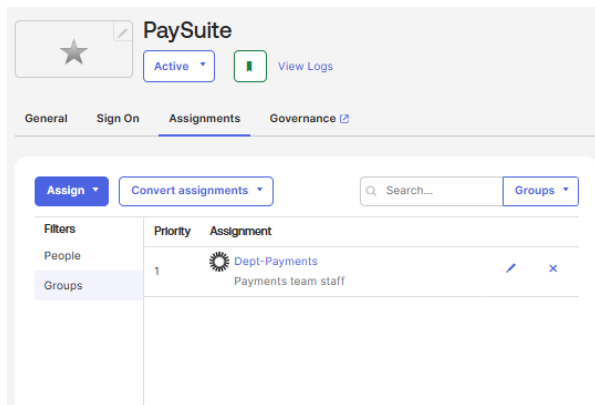
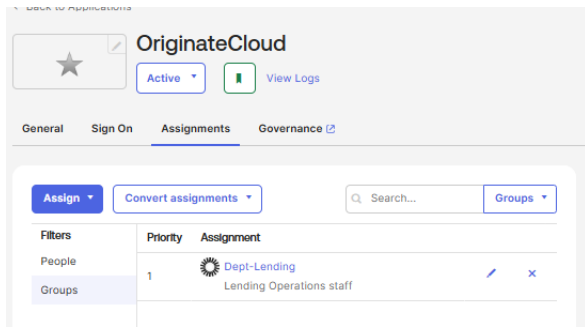
Added OriginateCloud as a Bookmark App in Okta to represent the lending application used by employees in the Lending department.



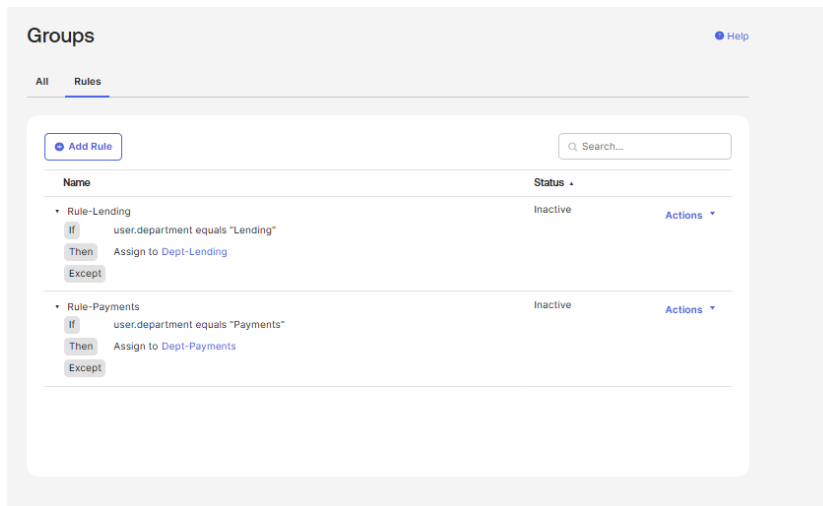
Added the three business applications used in the lab: OriginateCloud, PaySuite, and Meridian Intranet. These applications were later assigned to groups based on departmental access requirements.



Assigned each application to the appropriate group, including Meridian Intranet to All-Staff, OriginateCloud to Dept-Lending, and PaySuite to Dept-Payments. This allowed application access to be managed through group membership.



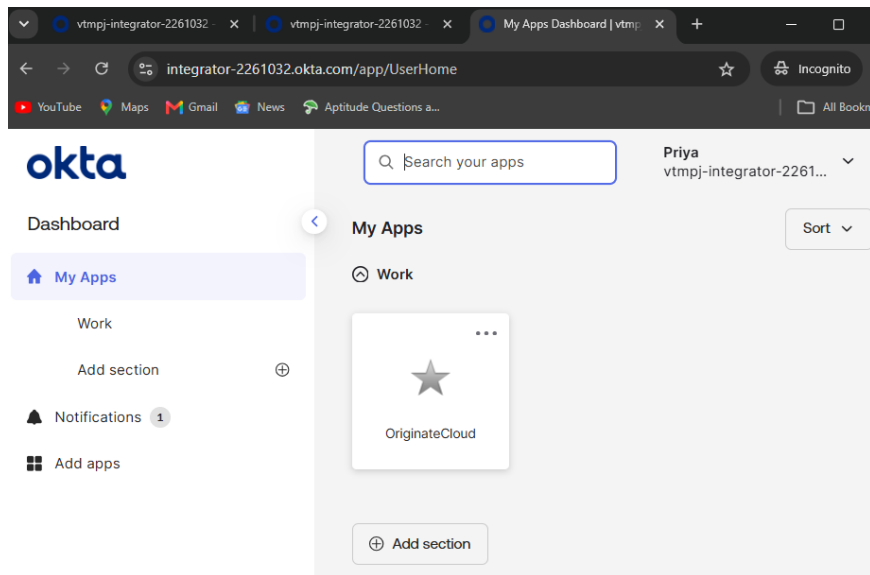
Created an automated rule that assigns users to the Dept-Lending group when their department attribute is set to Lending.



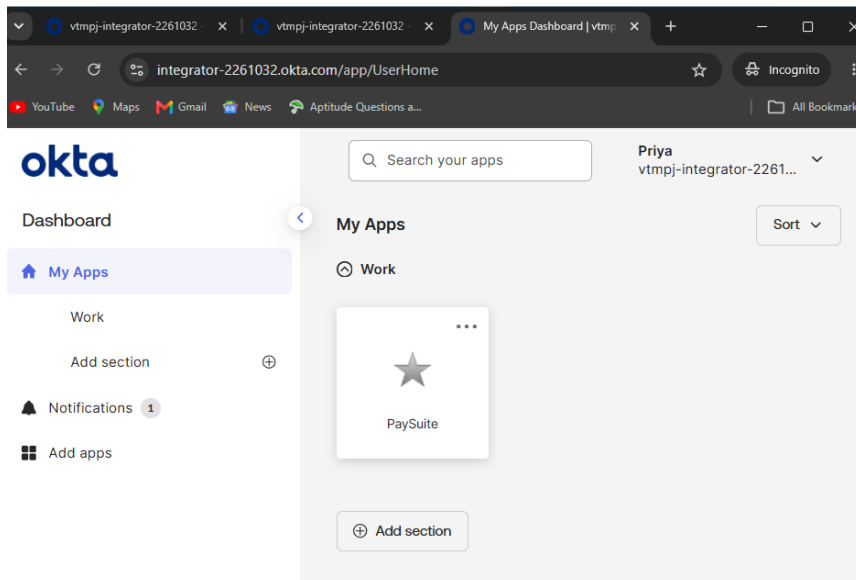
Created and activated the Lending and Payments group rules so users could be automatically placed into the correct department group based on their profile attributes.

Created Priya Sharma as a new test user in Okta to simulate the Joiner stage of the identity lifecycle.

Person & username	Primary email	Status
Priya Sharma priya.sharma@meridian-demo.test	priya.sharma@meridian-demo.test	Pending user action
Adithyakrishnan Sureshbabu ndzikqdfkxxjfaqcyv@vtmpj.com	ndzikqdfkxxjfaqcyv@vtmpj.com	Active

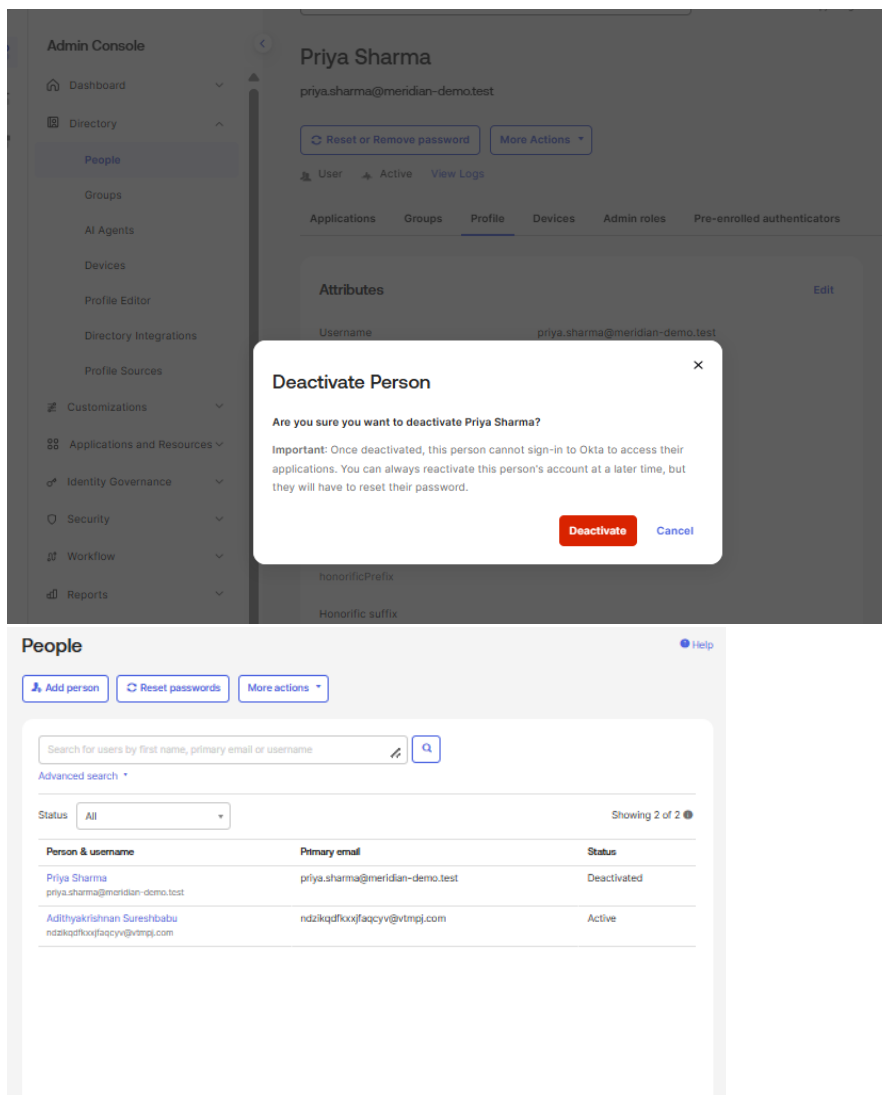


Set Priya's department to Lending and confirmed that OriginateCloud appeared on her user dashboard, demonstrating role-based access for a new employee.



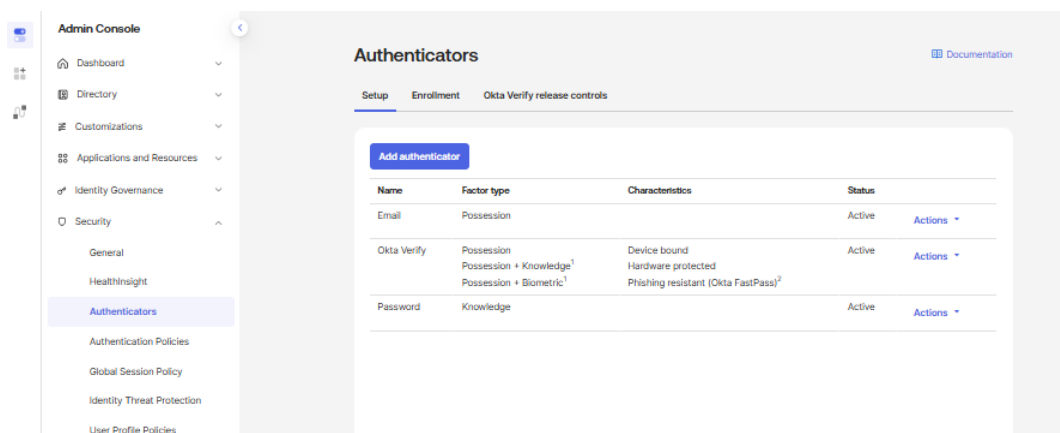
Changed Priya's department from Lending to Payments and confirmed that her access changed from OriginateCloud to PaySuite, demonstrating the Mover process.

Now we are processing the Leaver



Deactivated Priya's account to simulate the Leaver process and confirmed that her account status changed to Deactivated, preventing further sign-in.

Next doing the MFA for Mark John's account



Confirmed that Okta Verify was active and changed the authentication policy so Okta Verify became a required authenticator rather than optional.

Authenticators

Setup Enrollment Okta Verify release controls

OID Upgrade Change
Authenticator enrollment policy is evaluated alongside password policy

Edit Policy

Policy name
Default Policy

Policy description
The default policy applies in all situations if no other policy applies.

Assign to groups
☒ Everyone

Authenticators

☒ Email
Enrollment Disabled
Auto-enroll ☒ Auto-enroll using account profile email when possible

☒ Okta Verify
Enrollment Required
Grace period ☒ None ☐ By a due date ☐ After a number of skips

☐ Password
Enrollment Required
Grace period ☒ None ☐ By a due date ☐ After a number of skips

[Update policy](#) [Cancel](#)

Made okta verify required from optional

Password Knowledge factor

OID Upgrade Change
Password policy is evaluated alongside enrollment policy
Password policy configurations may require users to enroll in email or security question. Additionally, users will be given an option to enroll in Phone or Okta Verify, even if selected as optional or disabled in the enrollment policy.
See more: [enrollment and password policy relationship](#)

[Add New Password Policy](#)

1 Default Policy [Edit](#)

Default Policy

Description The default policy applies in all situations if no other policy applies.

Assigned to groups ☒ Everyone

Authentication Providers

Applies to Okta

Password Requirements

Minimum length 12 characters

Complexity requirements ☒ Lower case letter ☒ Upper case letter ☒ Number (0-9) ☒ Symbol (e.g., !@#\$%^&*) ☒ Does not contain part of username ☒ Does not contain first name ☒ Does not contain last name ☒ Maximum 2 consecutive repeating characters

Block restricted content ☐ Use an OEL statement to block restricted content
This option blocks passwords that match the Okta Expression Language statement below. Validation occurs additively after above complexity requirements are satisfied. Reference the password as "password.value".
[Learn more about Okta Expression Language](#)

Common password check ☒ Restrict use of common passwords

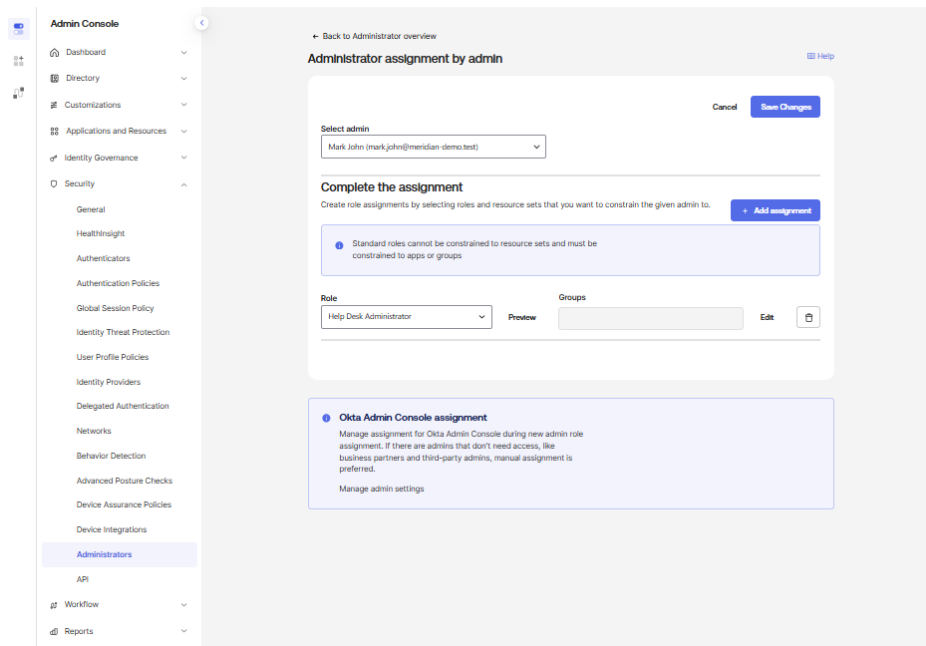
Password Security

Breached credentials protection ☒ Expire the password after this many days: 0 ☒ Log out user from Okta immediately ☐ Take custom actions using Workflows

Password age ☒ Enforce password history for last 4 passwords ☐ Minimum password age is 2 hours

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Updated the password policy to strengthen authentication requirements in line with the lab's security settings.



Assigned a Help Desk Administrator role to a test user instead of granting full administrative access, demonstrating least-privilege administration.

Overall Project Outcome

The completed lab demonstrated a practical Joiner, Mover and Leaver lifecycle using Okta.

The final access model was based on the principle that application access should be derived from user identity attributes rather than manually assigned to individual users.

The project demonstrated the following workflow:

Joiner

A new employee identity was created and assigned department information. That department attribute drove the user's role-based application access.

Mover

When the employee moved from Lending to Payments, the Department attribute was changed. The user's role access changed accordingly, demonstrating how automated lifecycle management can reduce privilege creep.

Leaver

When the employee left the organisation, the identity was deactivated to remove active access while retaining the user record for audit purposes.

The environment was then strengthened using:

- Multi-factor authentication
- Stronger password requirements
- Least-privilege administrative delegation